

Rick Nelson

Cloud Certified | Azure | AWS | GCP | OCI | Artificial Intelligence
Machine Learning | Data Analytics | Security | Identity Access Management

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🐙 [QuayWorld Cloud Repo](#)

Overview

I am a very ambitious person with over 10 years of professional IT experience. My most notable skills are Cloud Infrastructure, SQL, DevOps, Application Support, and Security. I enjoy learning new skills and currently pursuing various certifications to further validate my professional abilities. Currently, seeking long-term opportunities that are full-time and fully remote.

Certifications

Microsoft Azure

1. [Cloud Fundamentals](#)
2. [Artificial Intelligence \(AI\) Fundamentals](#)
3. [Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals](#)
4. [Data Fundamentals](#)

Oracle Cloud Infrastructure | OCI

1. [Cloud Certified Foundations Associate](#)
2. [Artificial Intelligence Certified Foundations Associate](#)

Amazon Web Services | AWS

1. [Cloud Practitioner](#)

Google Cloud Platform | GCP

1. [Cloud Digital Leader](#)

Professional Experience

Credit Suisse

May 2022 – Present

Application Support Engineer | Site Reliability & Technical Services

- Performed system debugging and user support for enterprise applications and cloud environments
 - AWS, Amazon EKS, AWS Lambda, Fargate, AWS ECS, Azure Functions, Azure Kubernetes Service, AWS & Azure Container Image Registries
- Provided daily support for business users and IT Teams for issues related to deployments, integrations, system errors, and various general inquiries.
- Adhered to organizational compliance and regulatory standards as it relates to managing users, groups, roles, policies, and keys in an effort to continuously enhance the organization's security posture at a global level.
 - Microsoft Entra (Azure Active Directory), Azure Policy, Azure Key Vault, AWS IAM, AWS KMS
- Conducted vulnerability assessments for containerized infrastructure.
- Executed SQL queries for data extraction, reporting, data update for user inquiries and analysis for system issues.
 - SQL Server (T-SQL), MongoDB, Oracle, Sybase, Postgres.
- Captured and reviewed logs to investigate user reported issues and automated system alerts
 - Cloud Trail, Azure Monitor, Splunk
- Utilized API tools to further analyze user issues and perform validation testing.

- Postman, SoapUI
- Managed dashboards to monitor system performance metrics, network outages, security events, and anomalous system activity for all business-critical applications, integrations, and infrastructure.
 - BigPanda, Grafana, ThousandEyes, along with platform agents to capture telemetry data.
- Review weekly Common Vulnerabilities and Exposures (CVE) reports with SecOps & Product Management Teams, developed remediation plans, and deployed patches during scheduled releases.
- Collaborated with development teams and product owners frequently to review issues backlog, monthly releases, and other business initiatives.
- Utilized DevOps tools to collaborate and manage issues backlog and communications with development teams and business stakeholders:
 - Azure DevOps, GitLab, Jira.
- Additional Technologies: Docker, Kubernetes, REST, cURL, Node.js .NET, IIS, Python, Linux, JetBrains IntelliJ, Visual Studio Code, Jupyter Notebooks, Infrastructure as Code

First Citizens Bank

September 2021 - March 2022

Business Systems Support Analyst II | Digital Banking

- Performed in-depth analysis and support for Digital Banking platform system and end-user inquiries.
 - SaaS-based web application services, Mobile device applications (iOS and Android), 3rd Party Integrations – Zelle, FiServ, Money Experience (MX)
- Provided support for issues related to system errors, system integrations, application data discrepancies, system patching, and general user support inquiries.
- Executed SQL queries for data extraction, reporting, data update for user inquiries and analysis for system issues.
 - SQL Server (T-SQL), MongoDB, Oracle, IBM DB2, Postgres.
- Performed system validation checks and testing via API Tools.
 - API Tools: ReadyAPI, SoapUI
- Managed dashboards and reports containing metrics related to critical system impact events, network latency, application performance, and anomalous user activity.
- Managed containerized infrastructure and components by assessing for supply chain vulnerabilities, implementing processes for image provenance, adversarial container security, and governance risk, and compliance (GRC).
- Conducted risk assessments of applications to ensure compliance with corporate security policies and adherence to industry best practices.
- Queried application logs to further analyze system operational events, validate application user access, audit network and security activity.
 - Splunk, Datadog, Dynatrace
- Participated in monthly release planning as a member of a project pod team to ensure the successful completion of deliverables and performed validation testing to ensure requirements have been fulfilled.
- Utilized DevOps tools to execute automated deployments and test scripts for monthly scheduled releases.
 - Jenkins, Chef, TestComplete, Docker
- Additional Technologies: Enterprise Service Bus (ESB), Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS), Apache, .NET, IIS, PowerShell, Python, Pip, PyCharm, Linux, Visual Studio Code, GitHub

Sensus

February 2020 - September 2021

2 - Application Engineer | Cloud Application Support & Professional Services

- Provided advanced level support for both internal teams and high-severity external customer issues.
- Performed a variety of support tasks as it relates to integration issues, network outages, failed deployments, escalations from junior support team, and occasional on-call support.
- Deployed new customer environments in our public cloud (AWS) – server specifications, database extraction\conversion, network endpoints, security groups, and application users.

- CloudFormation, Terraform, Amazon EKS, Amazon ECS, Amazon VPC, Amazon S3, AWS IAM
- Scheduled upgraded with customers and deployed new releases via automated tools.
 - AWS Elastic Beanstalk, AWS Code Deploy
- Collaborated with external vendors during projects for customers requiring custom 3rd party integrations.
- Performed post deployment validation tasks via automated test scripts, API calls, application performance test, and network QoS assessments.
 - Postman, AWS Lambda, Selenium
- Managed customer specific environmental documentation, VM snapshots, database backups, container images, and configuration files for disaster recovery purposes.
 - Amazon Elastic Container Registry (Amazon ECR), GitHub, JFrog
- Collaborated with InfoSec and Network Operations team on a frequent bases to review current deployment strategies and improve processes as needed in respect to latest known CVE's and best practices for network security.
- Queried various databases and reviewed logs for investigations related to data accuracy, modifications, or historical data for root cause analysis and enhanced reporting.
 - AWS CloudTrail, Splunk, SumoLogic, AWS DocumentDB, MongoDB, SQL Server, Oracle, Postgres

1 - Senior Systems Support Engineer

- Provided advanced level support for escalations related to Sensus data solutions and endpoints that reside on the Advanced Metering Infrastructure (AMI) communications network.
- Mentored and coached junior support engineers in an effort to upskill and enhance their professional growth.
- Managed internal knowledgebase and technical documentation for the department and held weekly knowledge transfer sessions.
 - Confluence, GitBook, GitHub
- Performed detailed analysis of web application services, AMI network data collectors, database servers, network communication paths, endpoint device firmware, and global/customer-specific system configuration.
 - AWS CloudTrail, Visual Studio Code, SQL Server, Oracle, Postgres, AWS DocumentDB, MongoDB
- Utilized network device and network performance tools to monitor AMI network infrastructure for system alerts, automated customer communications, meter diagnostics, and connectivity issues.
 - AWS CloudWatch, WireShark, Linux, Datadog, Splunk, and SumoLogic.

Cisco

April 2019 - February 2020

Technical Support Engineer – Cloud Security Applications

- Provided technical support to Cisco customers for various network security applications, physical servers, and network communication endpoints.
 - Cisco Security Analytics, Cisco Identity Services Engine (ISE), NetFlow, Cisco Catalyst 9000
- Provided technical guidance to customers undergoing a new implementation and existing customers that require assistance during an upgrade/patch.
- Collaborated with external vendors and customers to provide guidance on best practices and deployment strategies for Cisco security platform software and network endpoints.
- Performed in-depth review of customer's network topology and assisted with configuration of network firewalls, security protocols, certificate management, router & switch configuration, access control lists, domain policies.
- Administered digital certificates, keys for authentication, and encryption for application components.
- Analyzed diagnostic bundles (zip package) from customer environments that contain application logs, network packet capture, and other diagnostic information.
 - Visual Studio Code, Wireshark, Linux
- Provisioned test environments in VMware vCenter in an effort to replicate customer environments for validation testing and problem scenarios.
- Additional Technologies: Docker, Linux, Python, Apache, GitHub